

Lincolnshire Knee Clinic

Consultant-Led Specialist Knee Care

Patellar Stabilisation Recovery Guide

Postoperative recovery after patellar stabilisation

Introduction

Following patellar stabilisation surgery (e.g. MPFL reconstruction), the main goal is protecting the healing medial structures while preventing stiffness and muscle atrophy.

Brace Guidelines & Restrictions

- Keep the postoperative knee brace locked in extension (0 degrees) for walking and sleeping.
- Do not exceed the range of motion limits specified by your surgeon (usually restricted to 0-60 or 0-90 degrees in the first 4 weeks).
- Avoid twisting or pivoting on the operated leg.

Early Physical Therapy (Weeks 1 - 4)

- Engage quadriceps with static quad sets to maintain muscle tone.
- Perform straight leg raises ONLY while the brace is locked in full extension.
- Perform gentle passive knee bending within the allowed limits.